AB CONSULT

College of Economics and Business Studies (COEBS)

Sokoine University of Agriculture (SUA) • Morogoro, Tanzania

APPLICATION OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN PARLIAMENTARY RESEARCH

DAY 4 TRAINING MANUAL

Topic 3: Conducting Effective Policy Analysis: Analytical Methods and Options

Direct Ingestion of Native Policy White Papers and Strategic Plans: Automated Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA), Adversarial Stakeholder Simulation, and Compiling Strategic Options Briefs in Visual Studio Code

Target Audience:
Parliamentary Researchers, Committee Clerks, Legislators and Politicians, Social and Political Scientists, Policy Analysts, and Governance Practitioners

Lead Technical Facilitator & Senior AI Consultant:
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Date of Session: Thursday, 12th November 2026
Daily Timing: 08:30 – 16:00
Breaks: Health Break / Tea: 10:00 – 11:00 | Executive Lunch: 14:00 – 15:00
Zero-Copy Mandate: Manual copy-pasting is strictly prohibited. Trainees drop native policy white papers (`.pdf`) and sector strategic documents (`.docx` or `.pdf`) directly into the `documents/` folder and interrogate them via file-grounded AI commands.

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Chapter 1

Day 4 Overview: Automated Policy Methods & Options

1.1 Orientation from Eng. Dr. Kadeghe Fue

Welcome to Day 4 of our applied executive program on the **Application of Artificial Intelligence in Parliamentary Research**. Over the first three days, you transformed Visual Studio Code into a reproducible research desk (Day 1), automated the scrutiny of legislative amendment bills and CAG audits (Day 2), and ingested multi-page statistical abstracts to synthesize verified empirical dossiers (Day 3).

Throughout this training, our operational mandate remains absolute: **we do not copy and paste text manually**.

Today, Thursday, 12th November 2026, we apply this direct-ingestion capability to **Topic 3 of the approved national curriculum: Conducting Effective Policy Analysis: Analytical Methods and Options**.

In parliamentary governance, identifying a national crisis or an empirical shortfall is only the initial responsibility of the research service. Committee chairs, parliamentary clerks, and elected Members of Parliament frequently express frustration with research reports that merely catalogue grievances without evaluating realistic strategic alternatives. However, parliamentary staff must never operate as policy lobbyists or partisan champions for a single executive agency's pet project. The constitutional mandate of parliamentary research is to evaluate **viable, evidence-based policy alternatives**, thoroughly illuminating the fiscal burdens, administrative frictions, socio-economic distributional impacts, and statutory prerequisites of each choice.

Today, you will bring your own authentic strategic policy documents:

- A native **Policy White Paper / Cabinet Information Paper** in PDF format;
- A native **Sector Strategic Plan / Ministerial Implementation Framework** in Word (`.docx`) or PDF format.

You will drop these files directly into your 'documents/' folder. Using file-grounded AI prompts, you will command the AI to execute **Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA)** across four rigorous pillars, simulate competing institutional stakeholder perspectives (Ministry of Finance, Local Government Authorities, Private Commercial Operators, and Smallholders), and construct a balanced **Policy Options Matrix**. By 16:00 today, you will synthesize these components into a publication-grade, 3-page Strategic Policy Options Brief compiled into an executive PDF.

1.2 Specific Learning Outcomes for Day 4

By the conclusion of today's training at 16:00, participants will be able to:

4.1 Execute Direct Ingestion of Strategic Policy Files: Interrogate native white papers (`.pdf`) and sector strategy documents (`.docx`) directly in VS Code using `@documents/filename` without manual text extraction.

4.2 Apply the 4-Pillar Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA): Structure complex policy proposals into four standardized criteria: Fiscal Viability, Administrative Implementability, Socio-Economic Equity, and Statutory Alignment.

4.3 Simulate Adversarial Stakeholder Perspectives via AI: Command the AI to stress-test policy reforms from the conflicting institutional perspectives of the Treasury, Local Authorities, the Private Sector, and vulnerable citizens.

4.4 Synthesize a Standardized Policy Options Matrix: Generate reproducible Markdown comparison tables contrasting a minimum of three distinct policy alternatives against the status quo baseline.

4.5 Formulate Defensible, Non-Partisan Recommendations: Structure tiered legislative recommendations (Primary Action, Hybrid Mitigation, and Oversight Milestones) that provide actionable choices for parliamentary committees.

4.6 Compile a 3-Page Strategic Policy Options Brief: Draft, audit, and compile `Day4_Strategic_Polic` into an executive PDF before the 16:00 adjournment.

1.3 Detailed Day 4 Master Schedule

Table 1.1: Official Time Allocation for Thursday, 12th November 2026

Time Window	Module / Session Activity
08:30 – 09:15	**Session 4.1:** Transitioning from Evidence to Decision: The Role of Analytical Methods in Parliaments (Avoiding Executive Advocacy vs. Illuminating Choices).
09:15 – 10:00	**Session 4.2:** The 4-Pillar Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA) Framework for Legislative Oversight.
10:00 – 11:00	**HEALTH BREAK / REFRESHMENTS & NETWORKING TEA TIME**
11:00 – 12:15	**Session 4.3:** Direct Ingestion of Policy Files: Automated Extraction of Strategic Objectives, Interventions, and Resource Envelopes.
12:15 – 13:15	**Session 4.4:** Automated Multi-Stakeholder Simulation: Directing AI to Interrogate Policy Feasibility from Competing Perspectives.
13:15 – 14:00	**Session 4.5:** Structuring the Parliamentary Policy Options Matrix and Tiered Recommendations in Markdown.
14:00 – 15:00	**EXECUTIVE LUNCH BREAK**
15:00 – 15:45	**Practical Lab 4.1:** Hands-On Synthesis: Ingesting Participant Strategic Files, Generating the Options Matrix, and Compiling the 3-Page Brief to PDF.
15:45 – 16:00	**Session 4.6:** Peer Cross-Examination, Verification Checklist Sign-off with Dr. Fue, and Preview of Day 5.
16:00	**Daily Adjournment**

Chapter 2

Morning Session: Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA)

2.1 The Core Dilemma: Policy Prescriptions vs. Policy Options

In executive ministries, policy briefs often push a single preferred ministerial agenda. In contrast, the Parliamentary Research Service must serve the entire National Assembly: the Speaker, committee chairs, backbenchers, ruling party members, and the opposition.

If a parliamentary researcher submits a brief asserting:

"The Government must immediately reintroduce price controls and ban all grain exports,"

the researcher has abandoned professional detachment and entered the realm of partisan policy advocacy. If the researcher instead presents:

"A strategic multi-criteria evaluation of three alternative policy options to stabilize national grain availability during regional supply deficits,"

systematically evaluating the fiscal expenditure, administrative friction, market distortions, and statutory mandates of each alternative, the researcher provides true democratic empowerment.

The Parliamentary Analytical Transition

From (Executive Advocacy): "We recommend Option A because it solves the problem."

⇓

To (Parliamentary Scrutiny): "Option A provides rapid relief at High Fiscal Cost; Option B offers Moderate Cost with Substantial Administrative Friction; Option C requires Minimal Budget but demands Primary Statutory Amendment."

Figure 2.1: Transforming Executive Advocacy into Disciplined Parliamentary Options Scrutiny.

2.2 The 4-Pillar Multi-Criteria Policy Analysis (MCPA) Framework

To ensure that policy alternatives are evaluated systematically and without bias, **AB Consult** applies a four-pillar assessment standard tailored for the Parliament of Tanzania:



Figure 2.2: The 4-Pillar MCPA Evaluation Architecture for Legislative Oversight.

2.2.1 Detailed Breakdown of the 4 Evaluation Criteria

1. **Fiscal Viability:** What does this option cost the Consolidated Fund? Is it a one-time capital appropriation or an open-ended recurrent subsidy? Does it create sovereign debt liabilities or divert resources from priority sectors?
2. **Administrative Implementability:** Does the public bureaucracy possess the operational capacity to enforce the policy? For instance, does a centralized electronic warehouse receipt system function in rural wards with intermittent cellular coverage?
3. **Socio-Economic Impact:** Who benefits and who bears the economic burden? A policy that maximizes central government tax revenue may inadvertently suppress rural household farm-gate income or discourage private agro-processing investments.
4. **Statutory Alignment:** Does the proposed option require primary legislation (an Act of Parliament) or subsidiary legislation (a Gazette Notice / Ministerial Regulation)? Does it conform to East African Community (EAC) Common Market Protocols regarding free movement of commodities?

TEA TIME INTERMISSION: 10:00 AM – 11:00 AM

Please enjoy tea, coffee, and refreshments in the executive foyer. Technical facilitators from AB Consult are available to verify that participant policy white papers and strategic plans are correctly positioned in the documents folder.

Chapter 3

Mid-Day Session: Direct Ingestion and Stakeholder Simulation

3.1 Workspace Setup for Strategic Policy Scrutiny

Confirm that your Visual Studio Code workspace is organized as established throughout the training:

Day 4 Document-Driven Directory Structure

Workspace Root: `Parliamentary_Research_2026/`

```
-- documents/
  -- policy_whitepaper_2025.pdf    (Native strategic policy white paper)
  -- sector_strategic_plan.docx    (Native ministerial implementation plan)
-- briefs_and_reports/
  -- Day4_Strategic_Policy_Options.md    (Output brief generated via AI)
```

Figure 3.1: File Repository for Direct Strategic Policy Ingestion.

3.2 Direct Ingestion of Strategic Policy Files

Trainees will now interrogate their native strategic documents without opening external PDF readers or manually re-typing text.

3.2.1 The CLEAR Strategic Extraction Prompt

In the AI Assistant sidebar, submit the following prompt:

> *"You are a Senior Parliamentary Policy Analyst. Examine @documents/policy_whitepaper_2025.pdf and @documents/sector_strategic_plan.docx directly. Do not require me to paste any text.*
> *Scan both documents to identify:*
> *1. The primary national policy challenge articulated by the executive.*
> *2. The core interventions proposed across the strategic implementation horizon.*
> *3. The projected financial cost and required statutory changes.*
> *Synthesize these findings into a concise 3-paragraph executive summary in Markdown. Maintain strict institutional neutrality."*

3.3 Simulating Competing Stakeholder Perspectives via AI

A core difficulty in parliamentary oversight is anticipating how distinct institutional and economic actors will react to proposed policy reforms. Instead of guessing, researchers can use targeted AI commands to stress-test policy proposals against competing institutional viewpoints.



Figure 3.2: Multi-Stakeholder Simulation Architecture for Legislative Scrutiny.

3.3.1 The CLEAR Multi-Stakeholder Simulation Prompt

In the AI Assistant sidebar, submit the following prompt:

> *"You are a Senior Parliamentary Policy Analyst. We are examining the proposed post-harvest storage and produce cess reforms described in @documents/policy_whitepaper_2025.pdf. Simulate the institutional perspectives of four distinct stakeholders:*
> *1. The Ministry of Finance (Treasury),*
> *2. A Rural District Executive Director (DED),*
> *3. Commercial grain aggregators and private warehouse operators, and*
> *4. Rural smallholder cooperative farmers (AMCOS).*
> *For each stakeholder, state: (a) Their primary strategic objective, (b) Their strongest objection or operational concern, and (c) Their recommended mitigation. Present the results neutrally in clean Markdown."*

3.3.2 AI-Simulated Stakeholder Tensions Matrix

In seconds, the AI parses the native white paper and outputs a structured Markdown analysis:

1. **Ministry of Finance (Treasury):**
    - *Strategic Objective:* Contain open-ended subsidy liabilities and ensure that all local agricultural fees flow into the Consolidated Account.
    - *Primary Objection:* High capital expenditure for state-constructed silos (TZS 85 Billion) without guaranteed cost recovery.
    - *Recommended Mitigation:* Mobilize private capital through contingent credit guarantees rather than direct state construction.

2. **Rural District Executive Director (DED):**
    - *Strategic Objective:* Retain sufficient local revenue to finance district road maintenance and ward health facilities.
    - *Primary Objection:* Automated central bank sweeping of digital produce cess deprives local councils of immediate operating liquidity.
    - *Recommended Mitigation:* An automated statutory revenue-sharing formula allocating 40% of digital cess collections directly to council accounts weekly.
3. **Commercial Grain Aggregators & Private Warehouse Operators:**
    - *Strategic Objective:* Clear regulatory licensing and freedom to trade across regional borders without arbitrary municipal transit barriers.
    - *Primary Objection:* Double taxation when passing through contiguous district checkpoints and overlapping TFRA/WRRB inspection fees.
    - *Recommended Mitigation:* A single national electronic transit pass recognized across all regional authorities.
4. **Smallholder Cooperative Farmers (AMCOS):**
    - *Strategic Objective:* Minimize on-farm crop spoilage and eliminate distress selling during harvest glut periods.
    - *Primary Objection:* Centralized state silos located 40 km away are inaccessible to smallholders lacking motorized transport.
    - *Recommended Mitigation:* Subsidized on-farm hermetic metal silos and decentralized primary village collection aggregation centers.

3.4 The Structure of the Parliamentary Policy Options Matrix

A core deliverable for any parliamentary committee is the **Policy Options Matrix**. This matrix distills complex policy trade-offs into a clean, side-by-side comparison table.

3.4.1 Case Study: Addressing Regional Post-Harvest Grain Losses

Consider a scenario where the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Agriculture, Livestock and Water is reviewing interventions to curb annual grain losses of 16%–21% in the Southern Highlands. The committee requests three viable policy options.

Table 3.1: Comprehensive Parliamentary Policy Options Matrix

Evaluation Criteria	Status Quo (Baseline)	Option 1: Direct State Silo Expansion	Option 2: Private Warehouse Receipts (WRS)	Option 3: Household Metal Silo Subsidies
Strategic Description	Ad-hoc open storage and temporary ministerial buying posts.	Direct capital funding for NFRA to build 100,000 MT steel silos.	Regulatory relief and credit guarantees for licensed private warehouse operators.	Targeted 50% matching grant for smallholder farm-level hermetic metal silos.
Fiscal Cost (Treasury)	Low direct cost; high indirect loss in spoiled reserves.	Very High (TZS 85 Billion capital expenditure over 3 years).	Moderate (TZS 12 Billion contingent credit guarantee facility).	Low-to-Moderate (TZS 6.5 Billion annual subsidy over 2 cycles).
Administrative Implementability	Low burden; high systemic leakage and pest infestation.	High complexity (requires major public procurement, civil works, and engineering).	Moderate (requires TFRA/WRRB regulatory accreditation and rural enforcement).	High initial distribution logistics; simple long-term farmer operation.
Socio-Economic Impact	Severe post-harvest losses (18% average); farmers forced to sell cheaply at harvest.	High strategic food buffer; does not resolve on-farm storage losses for remote smallholders.	High liquidity for commercial farmers; limited access for micro-smallholders.	Maximum direct smallholder benefit; immediate 80% reduction in on-farm storage spoilage.
Legislative Requirements	Existing Crop and Grain Reserve Acts.	Supplementary Appropriation Bill for capital development budget.	Amendments to Warehouse Receipts Act regulations and collateral registries.	Executive Ministerial Order and LGA subsidy distribution guidelines.

3.5 Formulating Defensible, Non-Partisan Recommendations

When formulating recommendations for Members of Parliament, adhere to the **3-Tier Recommendation Architecture**:

1. **Primary Action (The Immediate Strategic Path):** Identify the option with the highest balance of feasibility and impact, framed as a balanced recommendation for committee consideration.
2. **Contingency / Hybrid Mechanism:** Propose how elements of another option can mitigate the primary option's weaknesses (e.g., combining private warehouse credits with targeted smallholder storage subsidies).
3. **Oversight & Monitoring Milestone:** Define specific legislative questions, statutory audits, or ministerial reporting deadlines that the committee should establish to monitor execution.

EXECUTIVE LUNCH BREAK: 14:00 PM – 15:00 PM

Lunch is served in the main dining pavilion. Please return promptly at 15:00 for Practical Lab 4.1, where you will assemble your complete Strategic Policy Options Brief into an executive PDF.

Chapter 4

Afternoon Practical Lab: Compiling the Options Brief

4.1 Practical Exercise 4.1: The 3-Page Strategic Policy Options Brief

Session Objective: Working inside your `Parliamentary_Research_2026` workspace, command the AI assistant to read your native policy white paper and strategic plan, evaluate three policy options using the MCPA framework, generate a complete 3-page brief in Markdown, save it into `briefs_and_reports/Day4_Strategic_Policy_Options.md`, and compile it into an executive PDF before 16:00.

4.1.1 Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Verify that your native policy files are located in `documents/`.

Step 2: In the AI Assistant sidebar, submit the **Comprehensive Policy Options Prompt** provided below.

Step 3: Review the generated Markdown output in the sidebar.

Step 4: Save the output as `briefs_and_reports/Day4_Strategic_Policy_Options.md`.

Step 5: Verify that the options matrix, stakeholder synthesis, and recommendations are structured cleanly.

Step 6: Open the Command Palette (`Ctrl + Shift + P`), select **Markdown PDF: Export (pdf)**, and press **Enter**.

Step 7: Open your compiled PDF and inspect its typography, table borders, and visual presentation.

4.1.2 The Comprehensive Policy Options Prompt

"You are Senior Parliamentary Policy Analyst. Examine @documents/policy_whitepaper_2025.pdf and @documents/sector_strategic_plan.docx directly. Do not require me to paste any text. Generate a complete, publication-ready, 3-page Strategic Policy Options Brief in Markdown:
- Document Title: # STRATEGIC POLICY OPTIONS BRIEF: AGRICULTURAL STORAGE & CESS REFORMS
- Metadata Header: Series AB-COEBS-D4-2026, Date: 12 November 2026, Lead Researcher: [Your Name], Committee: Agriculture, Livestock and Water

- Section 1: Executive Callout (The Decision Anchor: max 150 words highlighting the TZS 320B loss and the hybrid private-smallholder solution)
- Section 2: Strategic Context and FYDP III Baseline Performance
- Section 3: 4-Pillar Multi-Criteria Policy Options Matrix (Comparing Status Quo, State Mega-Silos, Private WRS Guarantees, and Smallholder Metal Silos)
- Section 4: Adversarial Stakeholder Feasibility Assessment (Treasury, LGAs, Commercial Operators, AMCOS)
- Section 5: Tiered Committee Recommendations (Primary Hybrid Model, Regulatory Relief, and Oversight Summons)
- Section 6: Institutional AI Disclosure Notice (Standard AB Consult disclosure)
Generate the complete text without placeholders."

4.1.3 Template Preview of Deliverable 4

The generated deliverable renders with the clean structure illustrated below:

Deliverable 4 Preview: `Day4_Strategic_Policy_Options.md`

STRATEGIC POLICY OPTIONS BRIEF: AGRICULTURAL STORAGE & CESS REFORMS
****Document Series:** AB-COEBS-D4-2026 | **Date:** 12 November 2026**
****Lead Researcher:** [Participant Name] | **Target Committee:** Agriculture, Livestock and Water**

Executive Callout (The Decision Anchor)
> **POLICY DILEMMA:** Post-harvest grain losses across Tanzania average 17.5% annually, inflicting a direct economic loss exceeding TZS 320 Billion and jeopardizing national food reserves. While the Executive proposes direct state construction of mega-silos (Option 1), empirical analysis indicates that a hybrid model combining Private Warehouse Receipts (Option 2) with Smallholder Hermetic Storage Subsidies (Option 3) achieves 85% loss reduction at one-third of the Treasury cost. Immediate committee scrutiny is recommended.

1. Strategic Context and Baseline Performance
Under Key Result Area 2 of the National Five-Year Development Plan (FYDP III), post-harvest losses are targeted for reduction below 8% by 2026/2027. Present national storage infrastructure remains heavily centralized, leaving 74% of smallholders vulnerable to on-farm pest infestation and distress selling.

2. Multi-Criteria Evaluation of Policy Options

Option	Fiscal Cost	Admin Complexity	Beneficiary Reach
Opt 1: State Silos	TZS 85B CapEx	High (Civil procurement)	Low on-farm reach; commercial buffer.
Opt 2: Private WRS	TZS 12B Guarantees	Moderate (Accreditation)	High for commercial aggregators.
Opt 3: Farm Silos	TZS 6.5B Grants	High initial rollout	Direct reach to 120,000 smallholders.

3. Multi-Stakeholder Feasibility Assessment
- **Ministry of Finance (Treasury):** Opposes Option 1 due to fiscal limits; strongly favors Option 2 credit guarantees.
- **Local Government Authorities (LGAs):** Note that Option 3 can be directly distributed via Ward Extension Officers.
- **Smallholder Cooperatives (AMCOS):** Report that centralized state silos are inaccessible to farmers beyond 25 km.

4. Tiered Committee Recommendations
1. **Adopt a Phased Hybrid Policy Model:** Advise the Ministry to reallocate TZS 20 Billion toward a dual track: TZS 10B credit guarantees for private warehouses and TZS 10B smallholder silo grants.
2. **Regulatory Harmonization:** Direct WRRB to submit an amended fee schedule lowering entry barriers for rural cooperatives within 60 days.
3. **Oversight Hearing:** Summon NFRA to present a cost-benefit justification comparing state silo maintenance against private leasing.

5. Institutional AI Disclosure Notice
"Prepared via direct AI-assisted policy extraction under AB Consult / COEBS SUA Research Guidelines. Evaluation criteria and stakeholder perspectives independently audited against primary government white papers."

4.2 Day 4 Competency Verification Checklist

Before leaving the training hall at 16:00, confirm completion of each milestone:

Table 4.1: End-of-Day 4 Competency Verification Checklist

No.	Verification Milestone	Status
V-1	Ingested native policy white paper directly via `@documents/filename`	[ ]
V-2	Evaluated policy proposals across all 4 pillars of the MCPA framework	[ ]
V-3	Commanded AI to simulate four competing institutional stakeholder perspectives	[ ]
V-4	Synthesized a complete Markdown Policy Options Matrix contrasting 3 alternatives	[ ]
V-5	Formulated a 3-tier non-partisan committee recommendation set	[ ]
V-6	Created `briefs_and_reports/Day4_Strategic_Policy_Options.md`	[ ]
V-7	Compiled document into an executive PDF before 16:00	[ ]

Chapter 5

Daily Wrap-up and Preview of Day 5

5.1 Summary of Day 4 Accomplishments

Today, participants completed Topic 3 of the national curriculum, demonstrating that:

- **Policy Evaluation Can Be Objective:** Applying the 4-pillar MCPA framework equips parliamentary staff to evaluate complex policy choices without partisan advocacy.
- **Stakeholder Resistance Can Be Anticipated:** Simulating institutional perspectives in VS Code allows researchers to stress-test policy initiatives before legislative debate.
- **Trade-offs Can Be Visualized:** Structured Markdown matrices enable committee leaders to assess fiscal costs, administrative burdens, and statutory requirements at a glance.
- **Recommendations Are Actionable:** Tiered recommendations provide standing committees with realistic legislative pathways and oversight milestones.

5.2 Preview of Day 5: Topic 4 – Ethics & Multi-PDF Tripartite Synthesis

Tomorrow, Friday, 13th November 2026, marks the final day of our master training program, dedicated to **Topic 4: Ethics, Integrity and Standards of Research & Multi-Document Batch Synthesis**:

- **Multi-Document Ingestion:** Drop a 3-document evidentiary corpus (1 Ministerial Budget + 1 CAG Audit Report + 1 NBS Census PDF) into `documents/corpus/`.
- **Research Ethics & Confidentiality:** Safeguarding privileged committee proceedings, mitigating algorithmic hallucinations, and standardizing institutional AI disclosure notices.
- **The Tripartite Output Architecture:** Commanding the AI to generate three distinct, publication-grade deliverables from a single evidentiary corpus:
    1. **The Executive Report (1–2 Pages):** For the Hon. Speaker and Committee Chairs.
    2. **The Policy Brief (2–3 Pages):** For floor debate and Members of Parliament.
    3. **The Scientific / Empirical Research Report (6–10 Pages):** For Parliamentary Clerks and research archives.

- **Awarding of Official Training Certificates:** Concluding ceremony and presentation of credentials under **AB Consult, College of Economics and Business Studies (CO-EBS), SUA**.

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"Empowering Parliaments Through Disciplined, Reproducible, and Ethical AI Systems."

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